BACKGROUNDERS
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Government of India

Rashtriya Panchayati Raj Diwas

Strengthening Grassroots Democracy in India

April 24, 2026

*Panchayati Raj Institutions form the backbone of India's grassroots democracy and have deep historical roots in village self-governance. They were strengthened by the 73rd Constitutional Amendment in 1993. With over **2.5 lakh Panchayats and 24.04 lakh elected representatives**, including **49.75% women**, local governance has become more inclusive. Digital interventions and platforms like **eGramSwaraj, Meri Panchayat, Panchayat NIRNAY, AuditOnline, SVAMITVA, Gram Manchitra, SabhaSaar, Local Government Directory, Training Management Portal and Gram Urja Swaraj** are improving transparency and efficiency. Strong funding support, capacity building, and scheme like **Rashtriya Gram Swaraj Abhiyan (RGSA)** further enhance capacity building, participatory planning and sustainable development.*

Local Self-Governance and Power Decentralisation in India

National Panchayati Raj Diwas is observed every year on 24th April across the nation. This day commemorates the establishment of the Panchayati Raj System as a formal structure of local self-governance. It marks the implementation of the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1992, which came into force in 1993. This amendment granted constitutional status to Panchayati Raj Institutions. The provisions related to Panchayats are laid down in Part IX of the Constitution of India.

The Panchayati Raj system strengthens democracy at the local level. It enables social and political empowerment by bringing governance closer to the people. Across the country, there are more than 2.5 lakh Panchayats, comprising about 24.04 lakh elected

On this occasion, the *Panchayat Advancement Index (PAI)–2.0* is being launched at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi along with three illustrated publications under the *Panchayat Dharohar Initiative.* A **monograph on the rural heritage of Tripura**, a **monograph on the rural heritage of Tirupati**, and ***Uttarkashi: Saumya Kashi – The Soul of Himalayan Heritage.***